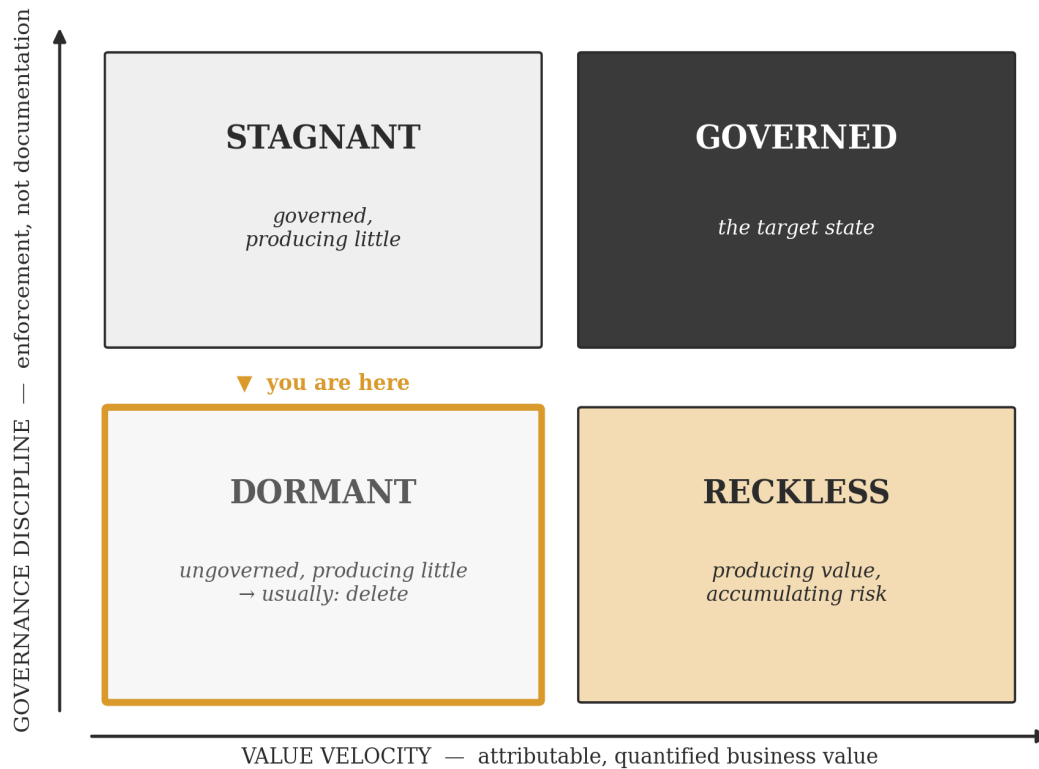


Your position: DORMANT

little value, little control



What this position means

Two very different organisations land here, and the next step depends on which one you are. The first is genuinely early: little AI in production, little governance built — a starting line, not a failure. The second has an estate full of residue: abandoned pilots, hackathon agents nobody decommissioned, duplicate tools, experiments promoted to permanence by inertia. Residue is not harmless — a dead system with a live, over-privileged connection to production data is pure downside: all risk, no return.

Direction of travel: Dormant → deleted, or → Governed

A triage decision, and for most Dormant systems the honest answer is deletion, not governance investment. Spending scarce governance effort on dead weight is itself a prioritisation failure. This position exists to give the estate permission to delete — often the highest-return governance action available.

The first three moves

- **1. List every system with live credentials and no attributable value.** Data connections, API keys, service accounts, standing integrations. This list is your real risk surface, and it is usually longer than anyone expects.
- **2. Decommission, access first, and document it.** Revoke credentials before archiving code. A documented decommissioning is a governance artifact — it proves the estate is managed, and it shrinks the surface everything else must govern.
- **3. If you are the early-days case: build the route before the estate grows.** This is the cheapest moment you will ever have to make the governed path the default path — standard access, default logging, named ownership from the first deployment. Organisations that do this never accumulate the Reckless cluster.

The characteristic obstacle

Organisational reluctance to kill things. Every dead pilot has a sponsor who would rather it be quietly maintained than publicly ended. Make deletion cheap and unceremonious: a standing decommissioning process, not a per-system negotiation.

Watch for: For the rare Dormant system with latent value: establish the value first, then route it through the Reckless-to-Governed path. Do not govern on speculation.

What to measure

- Systems decommissioned and documented (a number worth reporting to the board — it reads as control, because it is).
- Live over-privileged connections removed.
- For early-days organisations: share of new deployments entering through the governed route — target 100% while the count is still small.

Rescoring — the instrument itself

Your questionnaire result is a screening across the estate on average. The instrument proper is applied per system.

Governance Discipline (0–4):

0	No owner, no documentation, no monitoring. The system exists; nobody is accountable.
1	Owner named. No enforced controls, no monitoring baseline. Governance is a name on a list.
2	Policy exists and is <i>partially</i> enforced. Monitoring manual or intermittent. (A policy nobody can show is enforced scores 1, not 2.)
3	Policy enforced consistently. Active monitoring with a review cadence. Incident escalation documented <i>and tested</i> .
4	Every governance claim is demonstrable from the system's own telemetry. The system could face a regulator with evidence behind every claim.

Scores 0–1 plot Low; 3–4 High; a 2 is the transition zone — err low. **Value Velocity** is one question: can we attribute and quantify this system's KPI contribution, with a defensible number and methodology — yes or no?

The exercise, in five steps

Capture leadership's belief first and do not let anyone revise it. Build the real inventory from multiple signals — not from project registrations. Score every system with the rubric above, erring low where evidence is missing (missing evidence is the finding). Plot the map. Measure the distance between the belief and the data — that gap is the headline of the board report. Repeat quarterly: the Quadrant is a snapshot, and the direction of travel matters more than any single placement.

Status of this instrument

A working diagnostic from the field research behind *Govern or Fail: Why Enterprise AI Fails After the Demo* — deliberately published here rather than in the book, which stops where validation stops. The book is the diagnosis; this is the field kit. Use it, and where it breaks, tell me: governorfail.com. *Govern or Fail* launches September 2026.